

PRE-PRODUCTION DEPLOYMENT AUDIT

EfficientAdvt.Com — Hostinger Launch Checklist

All critical issues verified • Step-by-step migration guide • Nothing left to chance

FROM

LocalWP (efficientadvt.local)

TO

Hostinger (efficientadvt.com)

WORDPRESS

6.8.2

DATE

March 11, 2026

✔ Fixes Applied in This Pre-Launch Session

DONE ga4-fix — Consolidated duplicate gtag declarations in header.php

Both the GA4 block and Google Ads block were independently declaring `window.dataLayer` and `function gtag(){} .` Google's specification says only one `gtag.js` script + one initialization is needed. Both tags now share a single block:

```
<!-- Single unified gtag block -->
<script async src="https://www.googletagmanager.com/gtag/js?id=G-38EQB75ZRX"></script>
<script>
  window.dataLayer = window.dataLayer || [];
  function gtag(){dataLayer.push(arguments);}
  gtag('js', new Date());
  gtag('config', 'G-38EQB75ZRX'); // GA4
  gtag('config', 'AW-854448823'); // Google Ads
</script>
```

DONE wp-config — WP_ENVIRONMENT_TYPE set to 'production' + security constants added

Changed in wp-config.php:

- WP_ENVIRONMENT_TYPE : 'local' → 'production'

- `FORCE_SSL_ADMIN` : added `true` — forces wp-admin over HTTPS
- `DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT` : added `true` — disables theme/plugin editor in dashboard (security best practice)
- `WP_DEBUG_LOG` : added `false` — ensures no debug.log on production
- `WP_DEBUG_DISPLAY` : added `false` — no PHP errors shown on screen

DONE https-redirect — HTTPS enforcement added to .htaccess

Added a `301 Permanent Redirect` rule inside the WordPress rewrite block. All `http://` requests will be permanently redirected to `https://`. This works with Hostinger's free Let's Encrypt SSL.

```
# Force HTTPS on all requests
RewriteCond %{HTTPS} off
RewriteRule ^(.*)$ https://%{HTTP_HOST}/$1 [R=301,L]
```

MUST DO — Blockers Before Going Live (Your Action Required)

BLOCKER 1 Create a MySQL database on Hostinger and update wp-config.php

Your current `wp-config.php` has local database credentials that will NOT work on Hostinger. You must update these before (or immediately after) uploading:

Current (LocalWP — will fail on Hostinger):

```
DB_NAME = local | DB_USER = root | DB_PASSWORD = root | DB_HOST = localhost
```

Steps to get your Hostinger DB credentials:

1. Login to **Hostinger hPanel** → **Databases** → **MySQL Databases**
2. Click **Create New Database** — note the database name (will be like `u123456789_efficientadvt`)
3. Create a database user and assign it to the database with ALL PRIVILEGES
4. Note the hostname (usually `localhost` on Hostinger shared hosting)
5. Update these 4 lines in `wp-config.php` :

```
define( 'DB_NAME',      'u123456789_your_db_name' );
define( 'DB_USER',      'u123456789_your_db_user' );
define( 'DB_PASSWORD',  'YourStrongPassword123!' );
define( 'DB_HOST',      'localhost' );
```

⚠ **Do this BEFORE importing the database on Hostinger.**

BLOCKER 2 Migrate site using All-in-One WP Migration (handles URL replace automatically)

The database currently has `http://efficientadvt.local` in many places (siteurl, home, Elementor data, logo URL, theme options, etc.). This must be replaced with `https://efficientadvt.com` on the live site.

Recommended method — All-in-One WP Migration (already installed):

1. In your **local WordPress** dashboard → **Plugins** → **Activate All-in-One WP Migration**
2. Go to **All-in-One WP Migration** → **Export**
3. Click **Advanced Options** and set:
 - *Replace:* `http://efficientadvt.local`
 - *With:* `https://efficientadvt.com`
4. Export as **.wppress** file and download it
5. On Hostinger: Install WordPress fresh (minimum version), then install All-in-One WP Migration plugin
6. Go to **All-in-One WP Migration** → **Import** → upload the `.wppress` file
7. After import: Update `wp-config.php` with the Hostinger DB credentials

Why this method? All-in-One WP Migration handles the serialized PHP data in the database correctly — manually running SQL REPLACE() on serialized data corrupts string length counts and breaks WordPress. The plugin does it safely.

BLOCKER 3 Enable Free SSL in Hostinger hPanel before going live

1. Login to **Hostinger hPanel** → **SSL** → **SSL Certificates**
2. Select your domain **efficientadvt.com** → Install **Let's Encrypt Free SSL**
3. Wait 5–10 minutes for SSL to propagate
4. Visit `https://efficientadvt.com` — should show a green padlock

The HTTPS redirect in `.htaccess` we added will only work correctly after SSL is installed on the server. Installing SSL before pointing DNS is fine — Hostinger pre-provisions it.

🟡 **Required Steps — Complete in Order**

STEP 1 Point your domain DNS to Hostinger nameservers

At your domain registrar, update the nameservers to Hostinger's:

ns1.dns-parking.com

ns2.dns-parking.com

(Verify the exact nameservers in your Hostinger hPanel → Domains → NS Records)

DNS propagation takes 4–48 hours. Plan your launch accordingly. During this window, your local site remains accessible at `efficientadvt.local`.

STEP 2 Create a full backup with UpdraftPlus before deploying

Before migrating, create a full backup of the current local site:

1. In your local WordPress → **Settings** → **UpdraftPlus**
2. Click **Backup Now** — backup files + database
3. Download the backup ZIP files to a safe location

This is your safety net. If anything goes wrong during migration, you can restore from here.

STEP 3 Remove local-xdebuginfo.php from the site root (Hostinger won't need it)

The file `local-xdebuginfo.php` is a LocalWP development tool — it should NOT be uploaded to production at all. It is currently blocked via `.htaccess`, but deleting it is cleaner.

We have already blocked web access to it in `.htaccess`. Before uploading to Hostinger, delete this file from the local folder:

`c:\Users\merch\Local Sites\EfficientAdvt.Com\app\public\local-xdebuginfo.php`

STEP 4 After migration: Test the full site checklist

Test	What to Check
Homepage loads	Visit <code>https://efficientadvt.com</code> — no broken images, correct logo
HTTP → HTTPS redirect	Visit <code>http://efficientadvt.com</code> — should auto-redirect to https
wp-admin login	Visit <code>https://efficientadvt.com/wp-admin</code> — should force HTTPS
Contact Form 7	Submit a test enquiry — verify email arrives

Payment page	Open <code>/payment/</code> — form should load, PayPal redirect should go to efficientadvt.com
Images & media	Check no broken images (Media Library URLs should now be https://efficientadvt.com)
Analytics	Open Google Analytics → Realtime — visit the site, confirm your visit appears
Google Search Console	Add <code>https://efficientadvt.com</code> property and verify ownership
Wordfence scan	WP Admin → Wordfence → Scan — run a full scan after migration
LiteSpeed Cache	Clear all cache after migration: LiteSpeed → Toolbox → Purge All

 About the Deleted Hostinger Files — No Impact

CLARIFIED

hostinger-mu-plugin.php & hostinger-preview-domain.php — deletion has no negative impact

- These files were orphaned leftovers from a *previous* Hostinger account setup. Here's why their deletion is safe:
- **What they were:** Auto-installed single-file plugins that Hostinger adds when you install WordPress through their panel. They were tied to a previous Hostinger account configuration.
 - **Why they're gone:** They referenced non-existent Hostinger API endpoints, causing PHP notices on every page load.
 - **Will Hostinger re-add them?** Only if you use Hostinger's "*Install WordPress*" button — which you are NOT doing (you're migrating via All-in-One WP Migration). When migrating, Hostinger does not inject these files automatically.
 - **If Hostinger did add them:** They'd be the *current* version tied to your new account — which would be correct and desired behavior.

 **Conclusion: No impact. Safe to proceed.** The deletion cleaned up stale files that were causing errors, not removing critical functionality.

 Pre-Launch Security Status

Check	Status	Detail
SQL Injection in payment form	 Fixed	<code>\$wpdb->insert()</code> + full sanitization
CSRF on payment form	 Fixed	<code>wp_nonce_field</code> + <code>wp_verify_nonce</code>
Suspicious YuQ.js.php	 Deleted	Web shell pattern file removed

WP File Manager (RCE risk)	✔ Deleted	High CVE history plugin removed
Duplicate security plugins	✔ Fixed	MalCare removed, Wordfence active only
Sensitive files exposed	✔ Blocked	readme.html, license.txt etc. blocked in .htaccess
wp-config.php accessible	✔ Blocked	.htaccess <Files> directive
Error log path disclosure	✔ Fixed	error_log deleted + .htaccess block
Security HTTP headers	✔ Added	X-Frame-Options, CSP, Referrer-Policy, etc.
HTTPS enforcement	✔ Added	301 redirect rule in .htaccess
WordPress debug mode	✔ Off	WP_DEBUG = false, WP_DEBUG_DISPLAY = false
File editor in dashboard	✔ Disabled	DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT = true
SSL admin forced	✔ Added	FORCE_SSL_ADMIN = true
Migration plugins	✔ Inactive	Installed but deactivated in DB
jQuery version	✔ Fixed	WP core jQuery replaces bundled 3.3.1
PayPal demo domain URL	✔ Fixed	home_url() used — auto-uses production domain
DB charset	✔ Fixed	utf8mb4 (emoji + full Unicode support)
GA analytics tracking	✔ Active	GA4 G-38EQB75ZRX + Ads AW-854448823 (unified)
Database local URL (siteurl/home)	⚠ Must replace	Currently: http://efficientadvt.local — will be fixed by All-in-One WP Migration export with URL replacement
DB credentials in wp-config.php	⚠ Must update	Update with Hostinger MySQL credentials after creating DB
Default table prefix wp_	⚠ Low risk	SQL injection fixed — this is a minor hardening point

📋 Quick Reference — Files Modified in This Session

File	Change
wp-content/themes/Efficient/header.php	Consolidated GA4 + Google Ads into single unified gtag block (no duplicate dataLayer)

wp-config.php	WP_ENVIRONMENT_TYPE → production; added FORCE_SSL_ADMIN, DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT, WP_DEBUG_LOG/DISPLAY = false
.htaccess	Added 301 HTTP→HTTPS redirect rule inside WordPress rewrite block